

Hermes Basics — The Nurse's Cheat Sheet



Keep this beside your keyboard for your first week. Menus move as Hermes updates — when something looks different, the official docs are the truth: hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs

The one rule before anything — no patient data. Ever. No names, charts, screenshots, room numbers, or stories that could identify a patient. Hermes works on *your* life — learning, schedule, projects — never your patients.

1 Install

- Go to the official Hermes site: hermes-agent.nousresearch.com
- Download Hermes for your computer (Mac or Windows) and follow their install steps.
- Open it. If it asks about an AI model or provider, the default is fine to start — you can change it later.

2 Your first conversation

Hermes works like a chat: type, press enter. Say hello and tell it who you are. You cannot break anything by chatting.

```
I'm a nurse setting up my Nurse AI OS. I'll give you my SOUL file next — treat it as my standing instructions.
```

3 Give Hermes your SOUL file

Your SOUL file comes from the SOUL Quiz at nurse-ai-os.org (it downloads as **SOUL.md**). Easiest way: attach or drag the file into the chat, or paste its contents. Then say:

```
This is my SOUL file. Treat it as my standing instructions for how to support me. Confirm what you understood about my values and boundaries.
```

Read its summary back. Correct anything wrong — corrections stick.

4

Give Hermes your Starter Kit

The Starter Kit (ZIP from nurse-ai-os.org) is the folder skeleton of your system. Unzip it somewhere you'll find again (Documents is perfect). The folder is **My-Nurse-AI-OS**. Then tell Hermes:

```
My Nurse AI OS folder is at [location]. This is where my files live: my SOUL file,
my notes (03-Memory), my projects (04-Projects). Keep your work for me inside it.
```

5

Build your dashboard (one prompt)

```
Using my SOUL file, personalize the Local HTML Life Dashboard in my starter kit (08-
Integrations/Local-HTML-Life-Dashboard). Fill in my name, my top priorities in each
sphere, and my first goals and habits from my quiz answers. Save it as My-
Dashboard.html in my Nurse AI OS folder and tell me exactly where it is.
```

Open the file it creates in your browser and **bookmark it**. That's your station board.

Five phrases that do most of the work

You say	Hermes does
"Run my morning huddle."	Asks your #1 priority, offers three ways to help
"Give me a Kardex entry for this session."	Writes a 5-line handoff note to save in 03-Memory
"Make that correction permanent."	Turns your feedback into a standing rule
"Before you start, interview me like an admission assessment."	Asks questions before big tasks instead of guessing
"Show me your plan before you do anything."	Keeps your hand on every decision

If you feel lost

Normal. You only need the next step, never the whole map. Skip what confuses you, and bring questions to the weekly Lamp Huddle — every nurse there started exactly where you are.

Agents propose. Humans judge. Nurses steward.

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